Kevan Maxwell Davis

Staff Software Engineer | Frontend Architecture & AI Product Engineering

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Staff Software Engineer with 20 years of experience building user-facing commerce products, frontend architecture, and developer platforms. Deep TypeScript and React expertise combined with applied AI engineering across multimodal creative tools, model integrations, agent-driven workflows, and developer interfaces. Established technical lead and mentor with experience designing extensible product APIs and collaborating across teams.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Frontend: TypeScript, JavaScript, React, Remix, CSS Modules, single-page applications, frontend architecture, developer-facing APIs, user experience

AI products: Vercel AI SDK, OpenAI, Anthropic, Gemini, Pi, MCP, multimodal AI, agent orchestration, human-in-the-loop workflows

Backend & data: Node.js, Ruby on Rails, REST APIs, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Prisma, Docker, Kubernetes

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Shopify | Staff Software Engineer | 2021–2026

- Re-architected **Shopp-E**, an employee-facing multimodal AI product first started by another person, around an isomorphic **TypeScript/Vercel AI SDK** library shared by React web, CLI, and MCP clients; unified integrations across image, video, speech, and music models. Reached **100,000+ generated images** and an estimated **hundreds of daily users**.
- Designed a capability- and cost-aware model registry, resilient provider fallbacks, asynchronous generation flows, and remote polling for multi-minute video jobs, simplifying integration of new model types and providers.
- Expanded Shopify's extensible UI architecture into the Admin product-detail page, building the initial **Bundles** card and contributing to checkout and first-party Admin experiences; mentored junior engineers and an intern.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE (CONTINUED)

- Personally prototyped an AI system to update heavily customized merchant email templates; achieved **90% success on a small curated benchmark** using structured changes, rendered visual comparison, and validation feedback. Served as technical lead for a **six-engineer** production-development team; project canceled before launch.
- Built developer-focused AI experiences, including Pi IDE interaction surfaces (dialogs, prompts, notifications), rich Markdown editing, agent safety controls, and multi-agent review tools.
- Implemented product-field coverage and inheritance visualizations for multichannel commerce, helping merchants understand how channel-specific mapping rules resolve; prototyped enhancements to bulk editing for a late-2026 launch.

Shopify | Senior Software Engineer | 2019–2021

- Co-designed and prototyped the **developer API and React-based component model for Checkout UI Extensions**, partnering with a Principal Engineer on sandboxed remote UI integration. Core architectural concepts carried into Shopify's production extensibility platform.
- Helped integrate B2B commerce capabilities into Shopify after its acquisition of Handshake, contributing to business-customer and payment-terms initiatives.
- Built first-party post-checkout upsell features; named co-inventor on Shopify U.S. Patent 11,403,658.

Handshake (acquired by Shopify) | Senior Software Developer / Engineer | October 2014–May 2019

- Contributed to a multi-tenant wholesale commerce platform as one of 2–3 frontend engineers, helping lead React adoption and building self-service ordering and configurable catalog experiences.

Gilt Groupe | Web Developer → Senior Web Developer | April 2009–August 2014

- Developed core ecommerce UI systems, shared JavaScript libraries, build/asset infrastructure, cart and checkout flows, and responsive web experiences; mentored other engineers.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Mindspark Interactive Networks (Web Developer, 2008–2009); Tyler Technologies (Developer, 2006–2008); University of Texas at Arlington AI Lab (Research Assistant, through 2006).

EDUCATION

University of Texas at Arlington | Bachelor of Science, Computer Science